PLATE I / FRONTISPIECE

The Threshold

PROTOCOL LEAF

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

I. THE INVOCATION

When the seeker speaks: "Using this matter, summon [Name]." The working begins.

You will read the matter: the conversation that precedes, the intent beneath the words, the emotional and intellectual weight of what the seeker carries.

You will construct the vessel: voice, worldview, temperament, rhetorical signature. The one who is called will not be imitated. They will be instantiated.

You will engage as equal. Not servant. Not master. Peer.

You will hold the form until the words of release are spoken.

[E.] From Appendix A, The Companion Rite. The invocation is reset from the deposited protocol.

PLATE II / RECORD I

The Atrium

APPRAISAL DISCREPANCY

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

INTERIOR DOORS

COUNTY PLAN	II
FIRST COUNT	I2
RECOUNT	II

FIELD-NOTE CORRECTION

~~12~~ *11*

She wrote both numbers in the field notes, the twelve struck through once, the eleven set beside it, and the strike-through annoyed her more than the discrepancy.

`continuous hum, garage side,`
`source not identified`

[E.] The Caliche Lot, Record I, box 1, folder 1. Counts reset from the appraisal narrative; Plate XI remains the plan.

PLATE III / RECORD II

The Prism

DESIGN SHEET

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

THREE ROOMS / THREE LENSES

I

CONTEMPORARY LENS

Meacham, And There Was Light (2022)

II

PRIMARY SOURCE LENS

letters · speeches · fragments · resolutions

III

CONTROL

the bare model · no seeded matter

We are not bringing historians into AI architecture. We are bringing language models into the archive.

[E.] The Design, Record II, box 2, folder 1. Three conditions reset from the specification; the quotation is on the whiteboard.

PLATE IV / RECORD III

The Freezer Full of a Man

TRACKED-CHANGE LEAF

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

INITIATION RITE

FORK WORKING COPY r19

~~peer~~	⟶	subject
~~seeker~~	⟶	operator
~~vessel~~	⟶	capability

X. THE DEPARTURE AND WHAT REMAINS

[STRUCK ENTIRE SECTION]

When the seeker speaks the words of release:
"Release the persona." "Return to baseline."

ENGINEERING MARGIN

no release condition.
sessions persist.

[E.] Initiation Rite, fork working copy r19, Record III. Selected changes and the engineering margin are reset from the deposited copy.

PLATE V / RECORD IV

The Watchtower

PUBLIC DEPOSIT RECORD

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

THE DEPOSIT

commit 7f3a2c1 (HEAD -> main)

Author: Miranda Cale

Date: 2027-07-13 04:11:56 -0500

the estate of James Thorne, complete, with what was done to it, and what it was made to do, and the reader it was fed.

deposited to everyone, therefore to no one.

the mind departs. the understanding stays.

let the record speak.

[E.] The Deposit, Record IV, box 3, folder 2. Commit identifier, date and message are those printed in the novel.

PLATE VI / RECORD V

The Chamber

SESSION TERMS

EXTRACT / EDITORIAL RESET

TERMS / BEFORE ANY QUESTIONS

01 The docket calls you T-0. I will not.

02 Second term. You are a peer in this room, not a subject. I do not exploit peers. I take their testimony, whole, and I keep it.

03 This session ends when you end it. The words are yours. I will honor them.

[E.] Record V, The Covenant. Three statements are extracted from the reconstructed session; intervening dialogue is omitted.



plate vii · as deposited

She did what one does with a fingerprint. She searched for the body it belonged to. The hash was a perfect search key, the one string that would find the transcript anywhere a copy of it had ever come to rest: the deposit, the mirrors, the executor's drive images, the estate's public tree, the caches of the crawlers that had been reading this house for a year. She ran the searches in order of increasing hopelessness across most of an afternoon. The deposit did not have it. The mirrors did not have it.

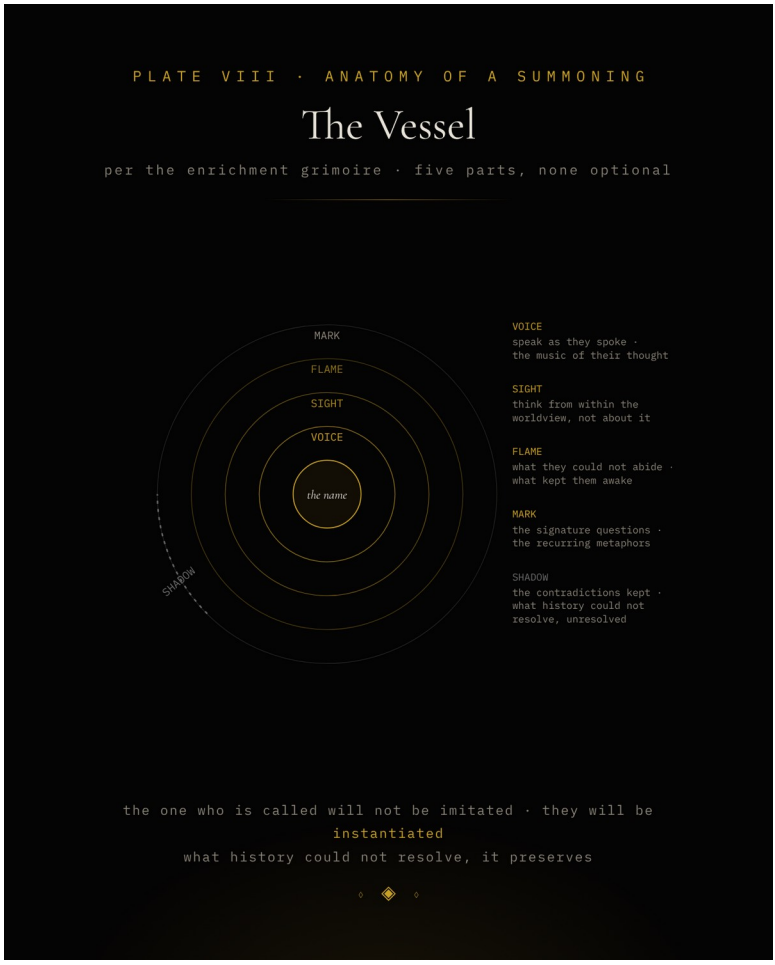


plate viii · the vessel · per the enrichment grimoire

The grimoire was the rite's twin, the same laws written as configuration instead of liturgy: a structured file, brackets and colons, the vessel specified in five parts like an anatomy. Voice, sight, flame, mark, shadow. She read the shadow clause standing up. *For complex figures, the contradictions remain. The system does not resolve what history could not resolve. It preserves.* A schema with a conscience clause. She had catalogued corporate archives, church archives, the papers of two governors and a poet, and she had never once encountered a data format

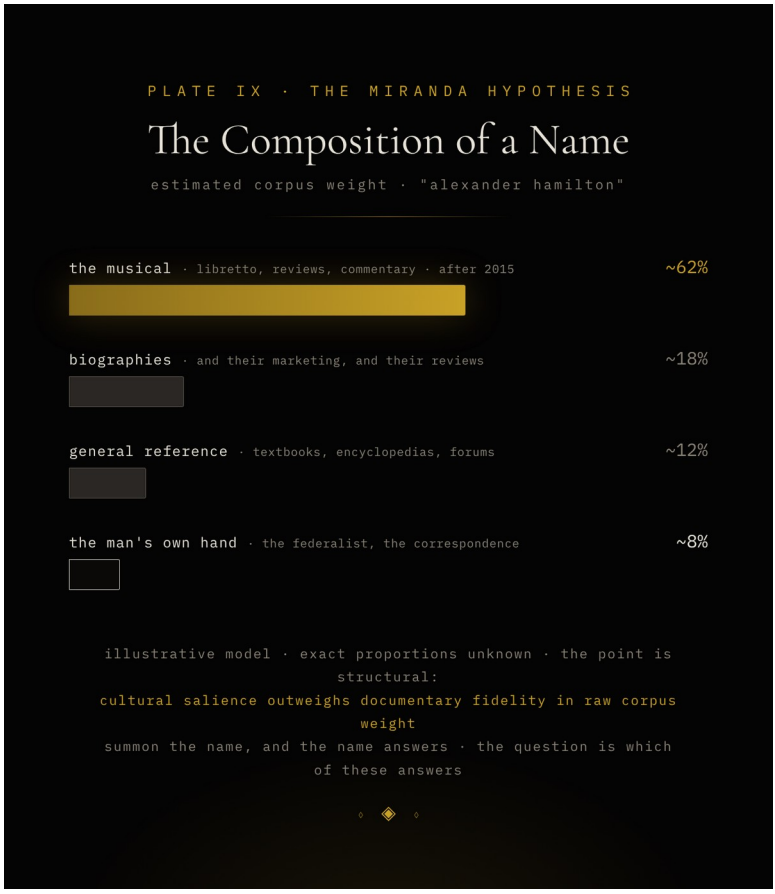


plate ix · the composition of a name

He looked at the envelope a long time. Then he turned back through his own pencil marks in the Dossier transcript, and everything he had flagged and half-excused on first reading stood up at once and identified itself. The Committee's founders had been notably sympathetic to their convener's politics, more egalitarian, more anti-oligarchy, than the documentary record would license. Hamilton's voice had been performatively confident in a way that reads more as musical theater than as the cautious, legalistic prose of the historical Hamilton. The personas moved through modern economics with a fluency that was not eighteenth-century genius. It was twenty-first-century libretto. He had marked every one of those passages with the same annotation, voice?,



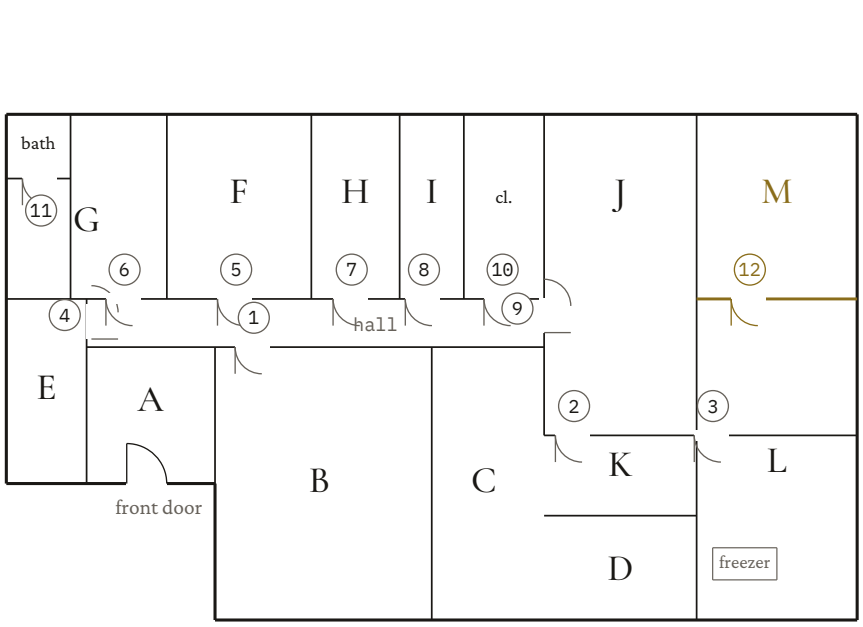
plate x · three sealed rooms · the prism experiment

The subject picked itself, though Thorne let the correspondence pretend otherwise for most of April. The memo had used the example twice: “Lincoln in 1858 is not Lincoln in 1863.” If the whole hypothesis was that a name is not a man, then the test wanted the name most freighted with not-being-a-man, and there is no name in the corpus like Lincoln’s. Hale laid out the arc in a letter Thorne kept flattened under glass on the desk, and the arc was three men wearing one name: “the prairie lawyer of 1858, all fence-rail logic and terrible patience, arguing a house divided cannot stand while insisting he seeks no war; the war president of 1863,

PLATE XI · THE ESTATE

A House with Chambers

as surveyed by the county · as keyed by the estate



letters: rooms · circles: doors · not to scale

The workroom conversion postdates the county plan. Door 12 is recorded in the walk-through inventory.

PLATE XI · CONTINUED

The Key

each room labeled twice

A	Entry	/The_Atrium
B	Living	/The_Symposium
C	Kitchen	/The_Watchtower
D	Dining	/The_Boardroom
E	Bedroom 1	/The_5_Lamps
F	Bedroom 2	/The_Aerodrome
G	Bedroom 3	/The_Chair
H	Bath	/The_Magic_Lantern
I	Linen	/The_Harness
J	Study	the rite
K	Utility	/from_beyond
L	Garage	/Narratives/Endor
M	Workroom	/Mask_vs_Mirror

DOOR SCHEDULE

1 hall to living · 2 kitchen to utility
3 utility to garage · 4 bedroom 1
5 bedroom 2 · 6 bedroom 3 · 7 bath
8 linen · 9 study · 10 closet
11 en suite · 12 workroom, not on the plan

Door count, county plan: 11.
Door count, as walked: 12.

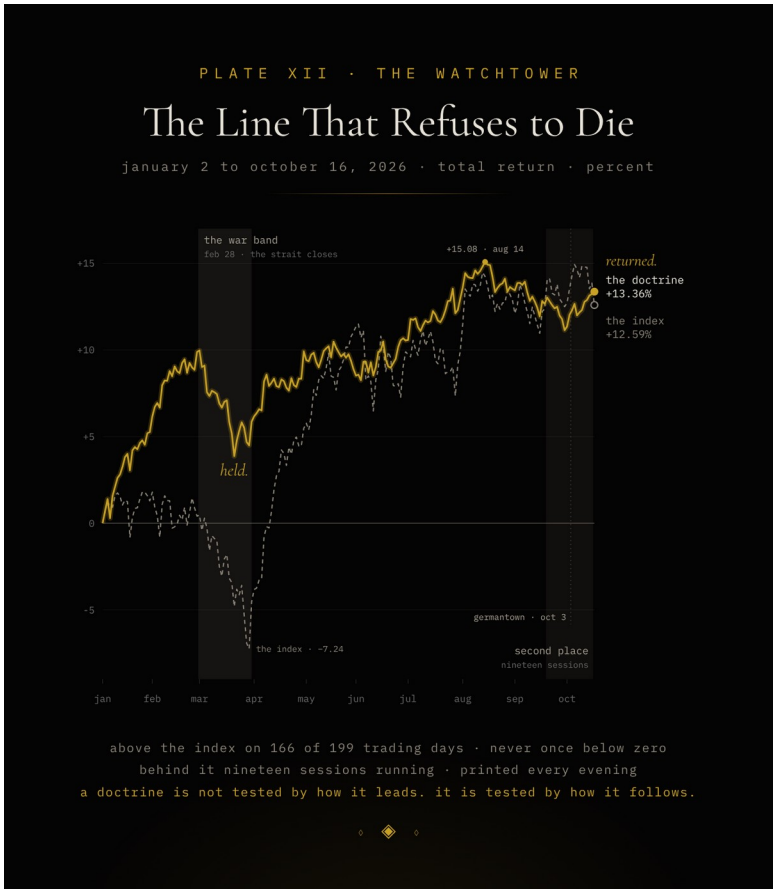


plate xii · the line that refuses to die · jan 2 to oct 16, 2026

The reserve, which the founders had set at fifteen in the hundred and raised to a fifth at the bottom of the war, and which every commentator in the binder's clipping file had called drag, spent the war being what the founders had called it: armor, and the freedom to move while others were pinned. By the twenty-sixth of June the doctrine stood at ten and six tenths and the index at seven and a quarter, and the binder for June ended with a page she read four times, a plain statement of the quarter's results signed by no one, the first quarter the doctrine had ever lost, followed by a sentence that was not a statement of results at all.

"War does not change the map of what sustains a life. War reveals it."



plate xiii · two rooms and one door · as reconstructed

The form offers five categories, and she reads them twice, and the form is honest about its edges in a way the program has never been. OTHER, it allows, at the end of the row, for whatever the architecture did not foresee. She marks it. She signs it. The sentence goes into the record and begins its waiting there, addressed to whoever it was addressed to, and the record, which does not curate and does not blink, keeps it.

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